

EARLY PHOTOGRAPHY

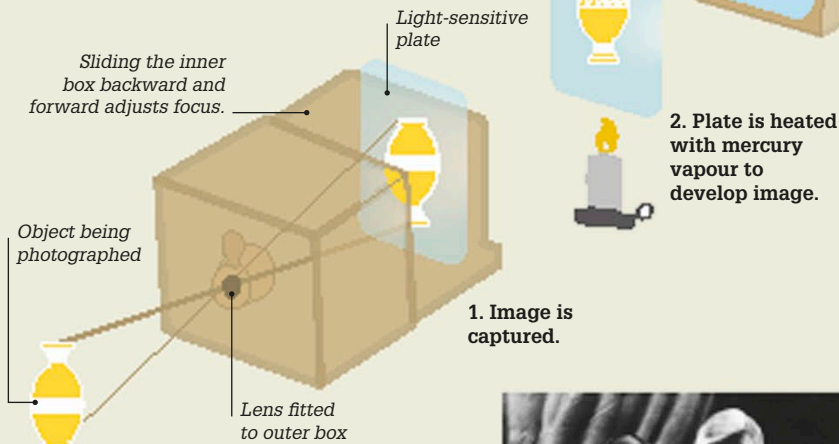
Two men contributed to the rise of photography after 1835. French artist Louis Daguerre began taking photographs on light-sensitive, silver-plated copper sheets. Named after the inventor, the photographs were called daguerreotypes. British scientist Henry Fox Talbot invented the calotype, a way of producing multiple photographs from a single negative.



Daguerreotype camera

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Alphonse Giroux designed the first commercial camera in 1839. The photographer viewed the object through a focusing screen at the back of the camera before replacing the screen with the light-sensitive plate.

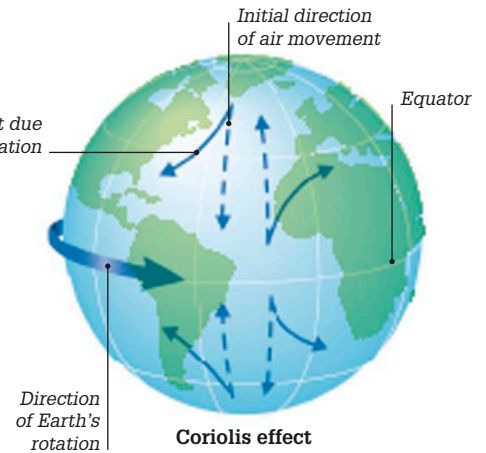


Competing processes

Although the daguerreotype process gave a clear image, it could not be duplicated. On the other hand, Fox Talbot's negatives (on light-sensitive paper), made by the Calotype process he patented in 1841, could be reproduced as positives (black-and-white photographs). So while daguerreotypes were more popular at first, negative photography would prove to be the way of the future.



Paper negative (reversed black-and-white image) by Henry Fox Talbot



1835

Coriolis effect

Gaspard-Gustave Coriolis showed that in the northern hemisphere, because of Earth's rotation, wind that was originally heading toward the equator will veer west, and wind originally heading away from the equator will veer east. In the southern hemisphere, the reverse happens. This phenomenon is known as the Coriolis effect.

1835

1836

Fast shooter

American gunsmith Samuel Colt patented the revolver—a handgun that could fire six shots without reloading. The gun's revolving cylinder contained six bullets, and a new bullet moved automatically into the firing position after each shot.

1837

Past ice ages

Geologist and paleontologist Louis Agassiz was the first person to argue that Earth underwent several ice ages (glacial periods in which a large part of the world is covered with ice) in the past. Agassiz studied glaciers and realized that the movement of ancient glaciers had shaped the landscape we see today, carving out valleys and depositing piled up rock debris (moraines).